

William M. Farmer

Preferred name: Bill.

Pronunciation of name: As expected.

Pronouns: he/him.

Hometown: South Bend, Indiana, USA.

Education

- Ph.D., mathematics, Wisconsin-Madison (1984).
- M.S., computer sciences, Wisconsin-Madison (1983).
- M.A., mathematics, Wisconsin-Madison (1980).
- B.A., mathematics, Notre Dame (1978).



Work experience

- Professor at McMaster University (2005–present).
- Associate Professor at McMaster University (1999–2005).
- Assistant Professor at St. Cloud State University (1997–1999).
- Lead Scientist at The MITRE Corporation (1985–1997).

Professional information

- *Research interests.* Logic, mathematical knowledge management, mechanized mathematics, and formal methods.
- *Released software.* W. M. Farmer, J. Guttman, and J. Thayer, *IMPS Interactive Mathematical Proof System*, developed at The MITRE Corporation (1990–1993).
- *Published textbook.* W. M. Farmer, *Simple Type Theory, Second Edition*, Birkhäuser/Springer (2025). Available at <https://link.springer.com/book/10.1007/978-3-031-85352-4>.
- *Administration.* Chair (2011–2016) and Acting Chair (2025), Dept. of Computing and Software, McMaster University.

Personal information

- *Family.* I am married and have a son and a daughter. I am the oldest of nine children. I have 41 cousins, 18 aunts and uncles, and 20 niblings (nieces and nephews).
- *Sports.* I am an avid basketball player and greatly enjoy hiking and canoeing.
- *Film.* Classics and foreign. Favorite directors are Bergman, Hitchcock, and Kurosawa.
- *Music.* I like all kinds of music. A favorite performer and composer is Mark O'Connor.
- *Reading.* Novels, history, biographies, plays, poetry, mythology, math papers, op-eds.
- *Volunteer work.* I have been a Scout leader for 26 years.
- *Citizenship.* I am a dual American and Canadian citizen.

In 10 years, I hope that I will: Be retired and writing a memoir and fictional short stories.